

KERALA | Tangled Web



VIJAYAN (LEFT) AND
ACHUTHANANDAN

SHANKAR

**THE FAC-
TIONAL WAR
IN KERALA'S
RULING LEFT
FRONT HAS
REACHED THE
INTERNET.**

The Vijayan-Achuthanandan spat has taken a new turn, with the battlefield now shifting from public platforms to

the virtual world. After literally effecting Chief Minister V.S. Achuthanandan's ouster from the CPI(M) Politburo, state secretary Pinarayi Vijayan has formed the Free Knowledge Democratic Alliance. It is meant to counter the state's free software movement which is dominated by the Achuthanandan camp. The chief minister has been a critic of proprietary software like microsoft and has hosted global free software guru Richard Stallman. Web traffic is turning Left in Kerala.

by M.G.Radhakrishnan



DELHI | Public Truth

The CAG report on public sector units is a scandal in numbers

419 Number of Central public sector undertakings.

Rs 4,77,191 cr invested in equity and loans in government companies, corporations and institutions.

284 Companies and corporations audited by CAG. Of these 185 earned profits, 70 were in the red and 24 were not operational.

30 Number of PSUs that were defunct or under liquidation.

13 Number of companies recommended for closure, winding up.

72 Number of companies with a negative net worth.

Rs 94,428 cr Accumulated losses of the 72 companies in 2007-08.

KOLKATA | Star Station



SUVASHIS MULLICK

TOLLYGUNGE METRO STATION

What the Left couldn't do in 30 years, Railways Minister Mamata Banerjee did in a month. No, it's not the fish curry on trains, but the cheer that the Bengal film industry has got. Banerjee announced that Tollygunge metro station will be renamed Uttam Kumar station after the legendary actor. The state government had done nothing to mark Kumar's contribution to Bengali cinema except building a grotesque statue in Tollygunge. Even communist diehard Soumitra Chatterjee admitted that a great wrong has finally been undone.

by Abhijit Dasgupta

SOURAV GANGULY IS SET TO FACE A DIFFERENT BALLGAME.

KOLKATA | Fresh Strokeplay

Beginning a new innings, off-field this time, former India captain Sourav Ganguly will be taking his first steps in cricket administration. Though not actually fighting the Cricket Association of Bengal (CAB) elections, the man called Dada will represent Bhukailash Sporting, a CAB-affiliated club, at the next CAB working committee meeting. The committee comprises representatives of 40 of the CAB's 121 affiliated clubs and representation is decided by rotation. Ganguly's looming presence inside the CAB is being seen as a direct declaration of opposition to the current CAB chief, Jagmohan Dalmiya. At one time Ganguly's mentor, Dalmiya has fallen out of Maharaja's favour.

by Elora Sen

